

Prickly customer

Woody thorns line the stems of brambles and roses. They can get tangled in animal fur and give a painful scratch to anyone that comes too near.

Nasty nettles

Stings are not like thorns. They are a type of hair that contain poison. When a predator brushes against the nettle, the sting stabs them, snaps off, and releases the poison. Ouch!

Water collects here and insects can't climb out.

Spines, called bracts, protect the flower.

Double defence

Teasels are well prepared for attack. Insects climbing up the stem will find spines, but if they head back down, they will drown in a leaf moat. This is the dip where two leaves meet, which fills with water when it rains.

Spot the plant

Hidden among the stones in African deserts are small, round plants. They have dull patterns that act as camouflage. You can see why they're called pebble plants.

